

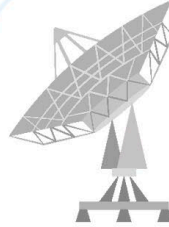


February

1

1985 Searching for aliens

The Search for Extraterrestrial Intelligence (SETI) Institute started looking for alien life in the Universe. It remains the only US research organization focused on finding evidence of extraterrestrial activity.



Born this day

1878 Alfréd Hajós, Hungarian swimmer. He was the first modern Olympic swimming champion to win two gold medals and one silver medal over his career.

1902 Langston Hughes, Black American poet and novelist. As a founder of the Harlem Renaissance movement, he wrote about the lives of working-class Black people.

1960 Greensboro protests

When four Black students were refused service in a Woolworth store in Greensboro, North Carolina, USA, they stayed put and staged a protest against racial segregation in the country. This marked the first of many Greensboro protests against inequality.

Also on this day

1895 Fountains Valley in Pretoria was declared the first protected nature reserve on the African continent by Paul Kruger, president of the South African Republic.

2003 Disaster struck when Space Shuttle *Columbia* exploded over Texas, USA, shortly before landing, killing the seven astronauts on board.

2009 Jóhanna Sigurðardóttir spent her first day as prime minister of Iceland. She became the first national head of government from the LGBTQ+ community.

